

Academic Writing

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ.

Writing Basics: From Letter to Sentence

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GENERAL OUTLINE:

➤ **Previous Lesson**

➤ **Previous HW**

➤ **New Lesson**

SESSION OUTLINE:

Today, we will be covering the followings:

➤ Presentation

- ✓ Letter, Word, Phrase, Clause, Statement, and Sentence

➤ Practice

- ✓ Activities/tasks (By Students)

➤ Production

- ✓ Ss will be writing their own work/productio

➤ Conclusion (By Instructor)



Aim:

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to identify letter, word, phrases clauses, and sentences correctly and apply them in your writing.

Warm up

Activity Type: Think-Pair-Share

Time: 5 minutes

Individually (1 min): Take a moment to reflect and answer the following questions:

1. How do words come together to create meaning?
2. What is the difference between sentence types and sentence functions?
3. Spot the difference between:
‘Before sunset’
‘Before the sun sets.’

Pair (2 mins): Discuss your answers with a partner.

Share (2 mins): Share your ideas and findings with the whole class.

Written Language Hierarchy

Letter: A single symbol in the alphabet.

Word: A combination of letters that together convey a specific meaning.

Sentence: A group of words that form a complete thought or idea, typically including a subject and predicate.

Paragraph: A collection of related sentences focused on a single main idea or theme. It provides structure and flow within writing.

Essay: A larger written work made up of multiple paragraphs, usually with an introduction, body, and conclusion. It explores a topic in greater depth.

Letter

- A single symbol in the alphabet.
- A letter is the smallest unit of the alphabet system.
- It has **no meaning by itself** (except in some cases like ‘A’ as an article).

A a

Word

- A group of letters arranged in particular order. (A-F-G-H-A-N)
- It has meaning (D-R-I-V-E-R) Driver

Examples: English: Book, Teacher, School, Hand

The word 'set' with different meanings:

1. **To put/place** → *She set the book on the table.*
2. **To adjust** → *Please set the clock to the right time.*
3. **To harden** → *The cement will set in an hour.*
4. **To establish/fix** → *They set new rules for the classroom.*
5. **A collection/group** → *He bought a new set of dishes.*
6. **To prepare** → *She set the table for dinner*



What Is a Phrase?

- When studying grammar and writing skills, it is important to understand the difference between **phrase**, **clause** and **sentence**.
- Understanding **clauses** and **phrases** will help you write better sentences.

Clause 1 (Independent)		Clause 2 (Dependent)	
Ahmad shouted	at his brother	because he was angry	.
	Phrase		
Sentence (Single Sentence)			

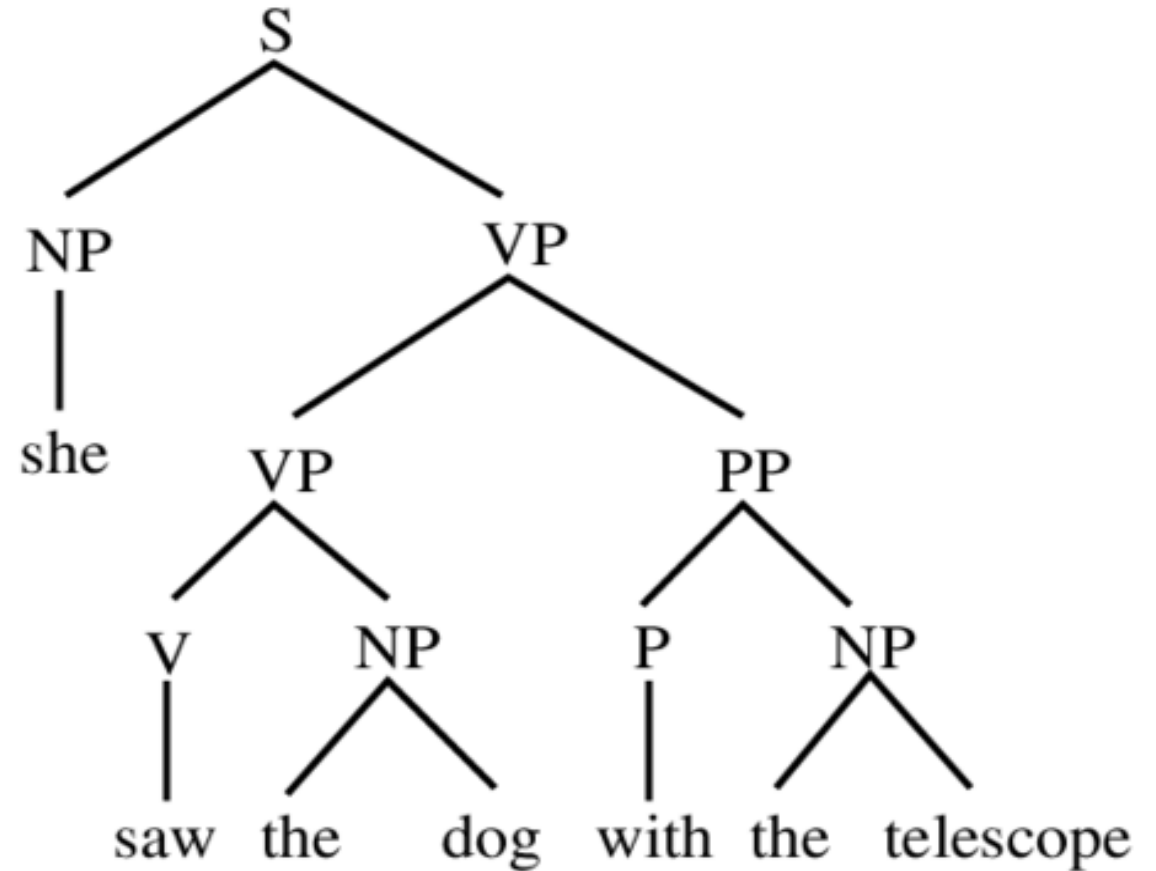
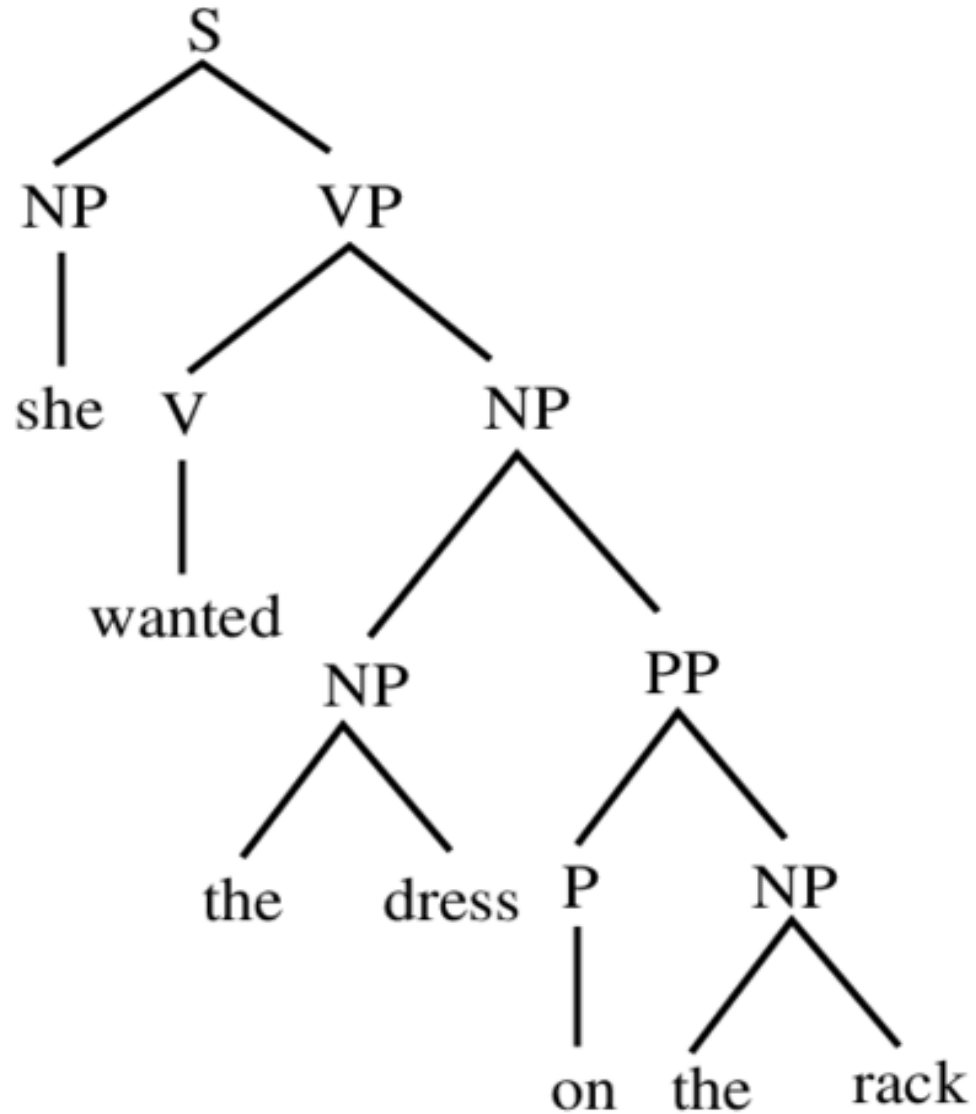
What Is a Phrase?

- A phrase is a group of words that work together but do not have both a subject and a verb.
- they help add details to sentences but **cannot stand alone** as a complete sentence.
- There are **five** main types of phrase in English.

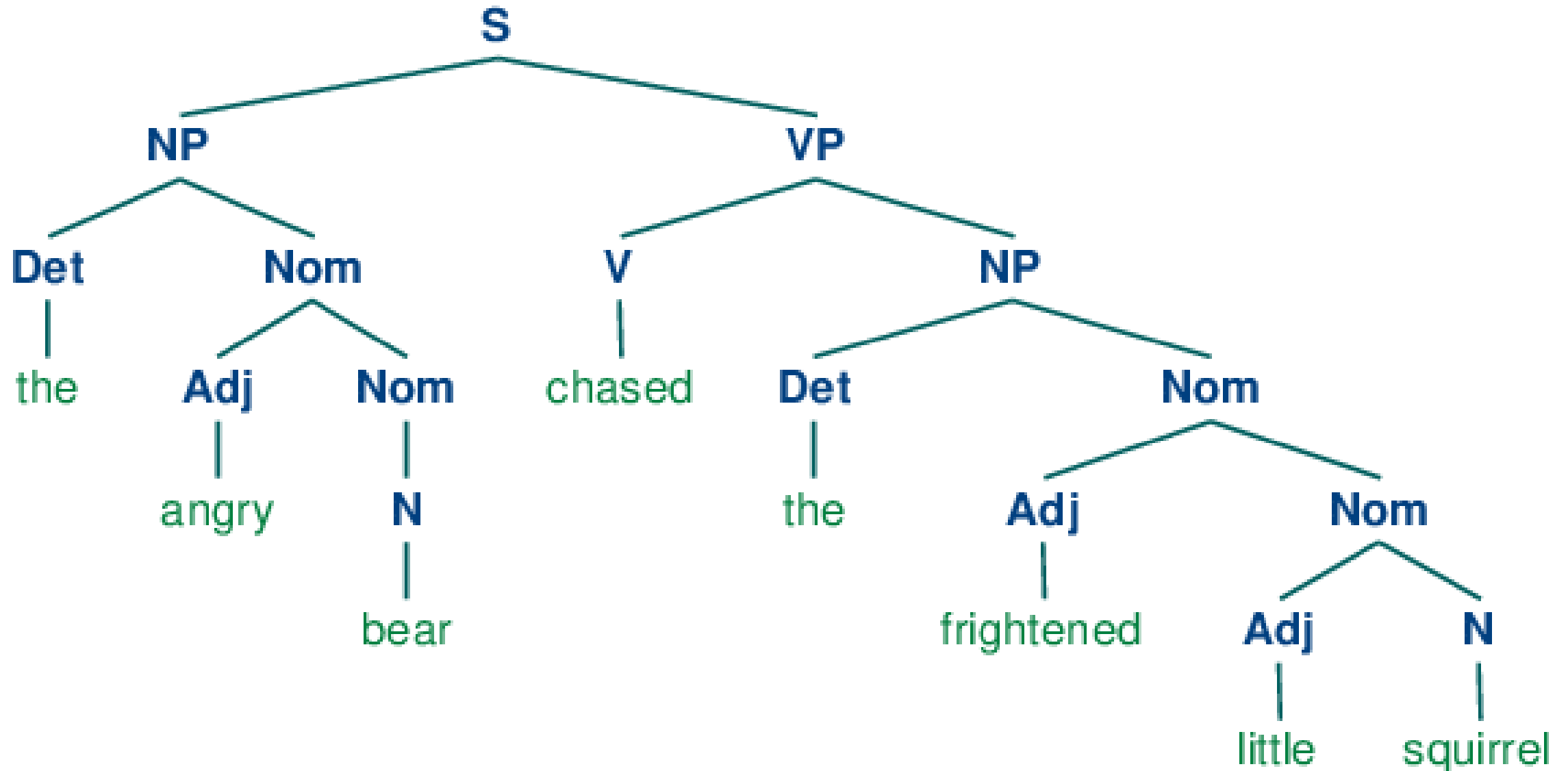
a red box	noun phrase
will go	verb phrase
quite big	adjective phrase
very slowly	adverb phrase
in the car	prepositional phrase

<i>he</i>	<i>is jumping</i>	<i>over</i>	<i>the</i>	<i>very lazy</i>	<i>dog</i>	<i>as fast as possible</i>
NP	VP	PrepP				AdvP
			NP			
				AdjP		

Two sentences with their phrase-structure trees



A sentence with its phrase-structure tree



Class Practice

A. Can you give me some examples of phrases?

B. Let's complete these sentences using a phrase:

‘He went to the market _____.’

‘I like _____.’

Class Practice

A. Can you give me some examples of phrases?

B. Let's complete these sentences using a phrase:

1. 'She went to the market _____. ' (*in the evening*)

2. 'I like _____. ' (*reading story books*)

What Is a Clause?

- A clause is a group of words that includes a subject **and** a verb.
There are basically **two** types of clause:
 1. An **independent clause** expresses a complete thought and can stand alone as a complete sentence, for example:
 - *she feels great*
 2. **Dependent clause:** This usually starts with a conjunction such as: *because, when, if*. A dependent clause cannot stand alone as a complete sentence because it does **NOT** express a complete thought, for example:
 - *because she runs daily*

Independent Clause

1. An independent clause

Example: *I usually buy popcorn*

- is a complete thought.
- It has a subject and a verb.

independent clause		
subject	verb	
<i>he</i>	<i>drinks</i>	<i>coffee</i>

An independent clause can form a complete sentence, if we capitalize the beginning (H) and end it with a full stop (.), a question mark (?) or an exclamation mark (!).

sentence			
subject	verb		
<i>He</i>	<i>drinks</i>	<i>coffee</i>	<i>.</i>
<i>Who</i>	<i>called</i>	<i>you</i>	<i>?</i>
<i>It</i>	<i>is</i>	<i>hot</i>	<i>!</i>

Independent Clause

Here are some more examples of **independent clauses** as sentences:

1. *He runs every morning.*
2. *They are not playing football.*
3. *What is your name?*
4. *He has finished his homework.*

Types of Clauses

1. An independent clause (main or complete clause)

Example: I usually buy popcorn

- is a complete thought.
- can stand by itself.

independent clause		
subject	verb	
<i>he</i>	<i>drinks</i>	<i>coffee</i>

2. A dependent clause (incomplete or subordinate clause)

Example: When I go to park

- is an incomplete thought.
- cannot stand by itself.

How to Identify the Dependent Clause?

You can spot a dependent clause by identifying the subordinating conjunction.

A subordinating conjunction creates a dependent clause that relies on the rest of the sentence for meaning.

The following list provides some examples of subordinating conjunctions.

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ after | ☐ although |
| ☐ as | ☐ because |
| ☐ before | ☐ even though |
| ☐ if | ☐ since |
| ☐ though | ☐ when |
| ☐ while | ☐ until |
| ☐ unless | ☐ whereas |

Independent Clause Vs. Dependent Clause

Independent and Dependent Clauses

Independent clause: When I go to the movies, I usually buy popcorn.

Dependent clause: I usually buy popcorn when I go to the movies.

Independent clause: I don't like the ocean because sharks scare me.

Dependent clause: I don't like the ocean because sharks scare me.

Proper Punctuation

Here are some examples of ways to combine independent and dependent clauses properly.

IC. IC.	I went to the store. I didn't buy any bread.
IC; IC.	I went to the store; I didn't buy any bread.
IC,CC IC.	I went to the store, but I didn't buy any bread.
IC; IM, IC.	I went to the store; however, I didn't buy any bread.
IC. IM, IC.	I went to the store. However, I didn't buy any bread.
DC, IC.	When I went to the store, I didn't buy any bread.
IC DC.	I didn't buy any bread when I went to the store.

Types of dependent clause

1. **adverb clause**: modifies a verb, adjective or another adverb. It usually start with words like: *because, since, if, although, when*
 - *I stayed home **because it was raining**.*
2. **noun clause**: acts as a noun in the sentence. It often starts with words like: *what, why, that, whether, who, how*
 - *I don't know **why she left early**.*
3. **relative clause** (also called **adjective clause**): "relates" to and describes the noun in an independent clause. It typically starts with a relative pronoun: *who, which, that, whom, whose*
 - *Here is the book **that I wanted to read***

Summary

- **Independent clauses** can stand alone as complete sentences.
- **Dependent clauses** need an independent clause to make sense.
- Clauses can be combined to form complex sentences.
- By understanding clauses, you can build more interesting and detailed sentences in English

Please note:

Learn more about the types of phrase, dependent clause at home and make sure you understand.

Subject and Object فاعل و مفعول

Examples:

- **He** helped **her**.
- **Ahmad and Wais** study **English**.
- **You** cook **rice**.

The Subject

فاعل

The Subject of a sentence is the person, thing, or idea that performs the action or is described in the sentence. It typically answers the question **Who? or What?** About/before the verb.

Example:

He helped **her**.

I/she/you/Ahmad/ I and you(we)/ they/ my friend...

Types of Subjects

1. **Simple Subject:** The main noun or pronoun that performs the action.

*Example: **He** studies late at night.*

2. **Complete Subject:** The simple subject along with its modifiers.

*Example: **The hardworking Afghan student** studies late at night.*

3. **Compound Subject:** Two or more subjects joined by a conjunction.

*Example: **Ahmad and Ali** prepare for their exams.*

4. **Implied Subject:** The subject is understood but not explicitly stated (common in commands).

*Example: **(You)** Complete your assignments on time! Close the door!*

The Object

مفعول

- The **object** of a sentence is the noun, pronoun, or phrase that receives the action of the verb.
- It answers the question **Whom? or What?** after the verb.
- Objects take no action

Example

He helped **her**.

--her/--you/--my friend/--us/--him...

Types of Objects

1. **Direct Object** – The noun or pronoun that receives the action of the verb directly.

Example: She bought **a book**. (*What did she buy? A book.*)

2. **Indirect Object** – The noun or pronoun that receives the direct object or benefits from the action.

Example: She gave **her friend** a book. (*To whom did she give the book? Her friend.*)

3. **Object of a Preposition** – The noun or pronoun that follows a preposition.

Example: She sat **on the chair**. (*'Chair' is the object of the preposition 'on'.*)

What is a verb?

- A **verb** is a word that **expresses an action or state** in a sentence.
- **Action verbs:** express doing something. → *She runs every morning.*
- **State verbs:** express a condition, state, or feeling. → *I know the answer.*

Asad ***drinks*** water.

Ahmad ***is*** a teacher.

We ***know*** the solution to this problem

What is a complements? It completes the meaning of the sentence.

Today is **Wednesday**. Ahmad is a **student**. Your car is **amazing**.

What Is a Sentence?

A sentence is a group of words that expresses a complete meaning.

It typically contains a **subject**(who or what the sentence is about) and a **predicate** (what the subject does or is)

Example:

Ahmad studies English.

~~**studies English Ahmad**~~

Before explaining this section, it would be beneficial to first cover the concepts of phrases and clauses.

Activity: Is it a sentence?

1. Running in the park.
2. He loves reading.
3. When I go to park.
4. I like reading he likes writing.
5. Because he was happy

What is a sentence?

Every sentence must have two main parts:

A subject: who or what the sentence is about.

A predicate:

- what the subject is doing or what is being said about the subject.
- everything in the sentence that says something about the subject.

This includes **verb**, **objects**, **complements**, and **adverbials**

Example:

The cat sleeps.

Subject: The cat

Predicate: sleeps

Challenging

1. The student in the blue clothes studies.

Verb:

Predicate:

2. The student in the blue clothes studies hard every semester.

Verb:

Predicate:

3. My brother bought himself a new car last week.

4. More than 3000 species of fish exist

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vSBATq2KvjQ&t=2s>

Or

C:\Users\DELL\Downloads\What is Subject, Verb, Object,
Complement, Modifier_ Grammatical Functions [basic English
grammar].mp4

Grammar for Writing

What is a Sentence Fragment?

A **sentence fragment** is an incomplete sentence. It lacks one or more key components (a subject, a verb, or a complete thought) that make it a complete sentence.

Features of Sentence Fragments:

A fragment may be missing:

1. A subject
2. A verb
3. A complete thought

Grammar for Writing

Examples of Sentence Fragments:

Missing Subject: Ran through the park.

(Who ran through the park?)

Missing Verb: The dog in the yard.

(What about the dog in the yard?)

Incomplete Thought: Because I was tired.

(What happened because you were tired?)

Grammar for Writing

Complete Sentence

A complete sentence has:

1. A subject (who or what the sentence is about)
2. A verb (what the subject is doing)
3. A complete thought (it makes sense on its own)

Examples of Complete Sentences:

The dog barked loudly.

I went to the store.

Grammar for Writing

How to Fix Sentence Fragments

To correct a fragment, add the missing part or attach it to a nearby sentence.

Example:

Teacher Ahmad enjoys teaching classes. And writing books. [fragment]

Teacher Ahmad enjoys teaching classes and writing books. [correct]

Fragment: Running through the park.

Correction: I saw a dog running through the park.

Fragment: Although it was raining.

Correction: Although it was raining, we continued our hike.

Grammar for Writing

Identify the Sentence Fragments:

- 1. Walking through the woods.**
- 2. The boy who won the race.**
- 3. After the movie was over, we went for coffee.**
- 4. Since I didn't have my homework.**
- 5. She was laughing**

Rewrite the Fragments to Form Complete Sentences:

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

Types of Sentences(**By purpose**)

A sentence can communicate

- o a statement (I am studying.) → 1- **Declarative**
- o a command/request (Go away.) → 2- **Imperative**
- o an exclamation (I'm so excited!) → 3- **Exclamatory**
- o a question (What time is it?) → 4- **Interrogative**

A sentence is composed of one or more clauses.

Activity: Identify the sentence types (By purpose)

- **Can you help me?**
- **What a nice book!**
- **Please leave the class.**
- **I do not know what your name is.**
- **What a great day!**

Watch the Video

- ..\Videos\English Sentence Structure - English Grammar Lesson.mp4

Types of Sentences (**By Structure**)

Sentences are divided into four categories: simple sentences, compound sentences, complex sentences, and compound-complex sentences.

1) Simple Sentences

Definition	A simple sentence contains one independent clause.
Examples	• He reads books. • Who is your best friend? • He ate his lunch, took a walk, and went back to work. (series of actions)
Structure	<i>Subject + Verb + Object</i> <i>They make Ice cream. He writes a letter.</i> <i>Subject + verb + Complement.</i> <i>They are happy.</i>

Types of Sentences (**By Structure**)

2) *Compound Sentences*

Definition	A compound sentence contains two independent clauses joined by a conjunction. A coordinating conjunction (for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so) often links the two independent clauses and is preceded by a comma.
Examples	• He wanted to go on vacation, so he saved up his money. • I like apples, but my brother loves bananas. • I like apples. My brother loves bananas. • Ali loves to read, and he also loves to write. • He didn't study for the test, so he didn't pass.
Structure	• Independent clause+ coordinating conjunction + independent clause

Watch the video and note the important points.

- Simple Sentence
- Compound Sentence

Types of Sentences (**By Structure**) Cont'd

3) Complex Sentences

Definition	A complex sentence contains one independent clause and one or more dependent clauses. A complex sentence will include at least one subordinating conjunction.
Examples	• He went to class even though he was sick. • As Ahmad was arriving to work, he realized he forgot his lunch. • When he arrived, everyone was already there. • He reads books because he loves stories. • Because he loves stories, he reads books.
Structure	Independent clause+(subordinating conjunction)+dependent clause.

Types of Sentences (**By Structure**) Cont'd

4) *Compound-complex Sentences*

Definition	A compound-complex sentence combines complex sentence and compound sentence forms. A compound-complex sentence contains two or more independent clauses and one or more dependent clauses.
------------	--

- | | |
|----------|---|
| Examples | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• He reads book, and his brother watches movies because they enjoy storytelling.• I try to eat healthy food, but because fast food is so convenient, I cannot maintain a healthy diet.• If he got the job, he would have to commute 50 miles to work, so he decided the job was not worth it. |
|----------|---|

Compound-Complex sentence includes:

At least two independent clauses (like a compound sentence)

At least one dependent clause (like a complex sentence)

Example: Although she was tired, she completed her homework, **and** she went to bed early.

Structure and Components:

Independent clause 1 + Coordinating conjunction + Independent clause 2 +

Subordinating conjunction + Dependent clause

1. **Coordinating conjunctions:** Used to link independent clauses. (e.g., and, but, or, nor, for, so, yet).
2. **Subordinating Conjunctions:** Used to introduce dependent clauses (e.g., although, because, since, if, while, when, who, where, though)

Activity: Identify the sentence type(By structure)

1. They went to the store and bought apples.
2. Although it was raining, we went to outside.
3. He is tall.
4. He did his homework, took a walk, and went back home.
5. The sun set behind the mountains.
6. I wanted to go to the store, but I didn't have enough time.
7. Although she was tired, she finished her homework.
8. He went to the gym, and he worked out for an hour because he wanted to get fit.

Activity: create your own sentences

1. Simple Sentence _____
2. Compound Sentence _____
3. Complex Sentence _____
4. Compound-complex Sentence _____

Let's practice more

Activity: Clause Identification

Identify the independent and dependent clauses in the following sentences.

Then, name the type of the sentences.

1. I missed the bus because I woke up late, but my friend gave me a ride.
2. She went to the park because she wanted to exercise.
3. I enjoy reading books, but my brother prefers watching movies.
4. After the meeting ended, we went to lunch, but I could not eat because I was feeling sick.
5. The teacher asked a question, and the student answered it

Task : *Sentence Construction* (10 minutes)

Each group will create the followings:

1. two simple sentences;
2. tow compound sentences;
3. one complex sentence; and
4. one compound-complex sentence.

Choose the correct conjunctions from the two options provided to fill in the blanks.

He enjoys reading novels, _____ he does not often have time for it, _____ he always tries to read at least one book a month.

Options:

- a) although
- b) because
- c) and
- d) but
- e) even though

Answer:

He enjoys reading novels, **although** he doesn't often have time for it, **but** he always tries to read at least one book a month.

Production

Homework

- 1. Learn more about phrases/Clauses and their types at home, and ensure that you understand them.**
- 2. Write a sentence consisting of all types of phrases.**
- 3. Write a paragraph consisting of all types of sentences.**
- 4. Differentiate between a phrase, a clause and a sentence.**
- 5. Write the summary of the lesson**
- 6. Bring them in the next session.**